The Well-Tempered clAIvier

Fugue XXII in B-flat minor, six voices: Tombeau "Ma fin est mon commencement" (crab fugue)

Keyboard - six voices

Claude / Sam (subject after J. S. Bach, BWV 867, ending B-A-C-H)

I. Exposition (alto, tenor, bass, soprano)

Grave, alla breve -- the second half is the first played backwards (♩ = 88)

Soprano

Mezzo-soprano

Subject (after BWV 867, ending B-A-C-H)

Alto

Answer (tonal, F minor)

Tenor

Bass

Cantus firmus

9

codetta

soprano: answer

Answer (soprano, F minor)

S

Mz

A

T

Subject (bass)

B
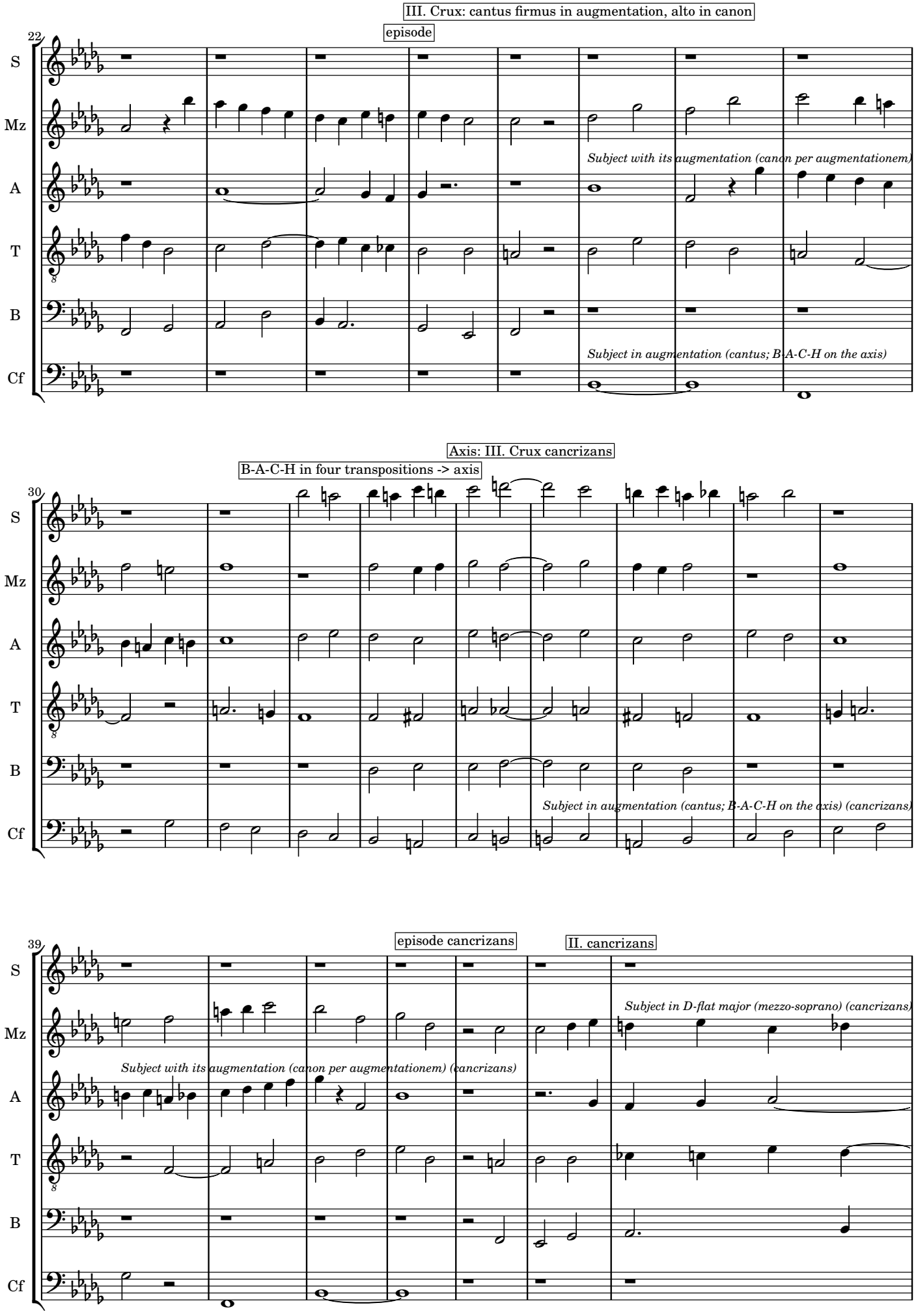
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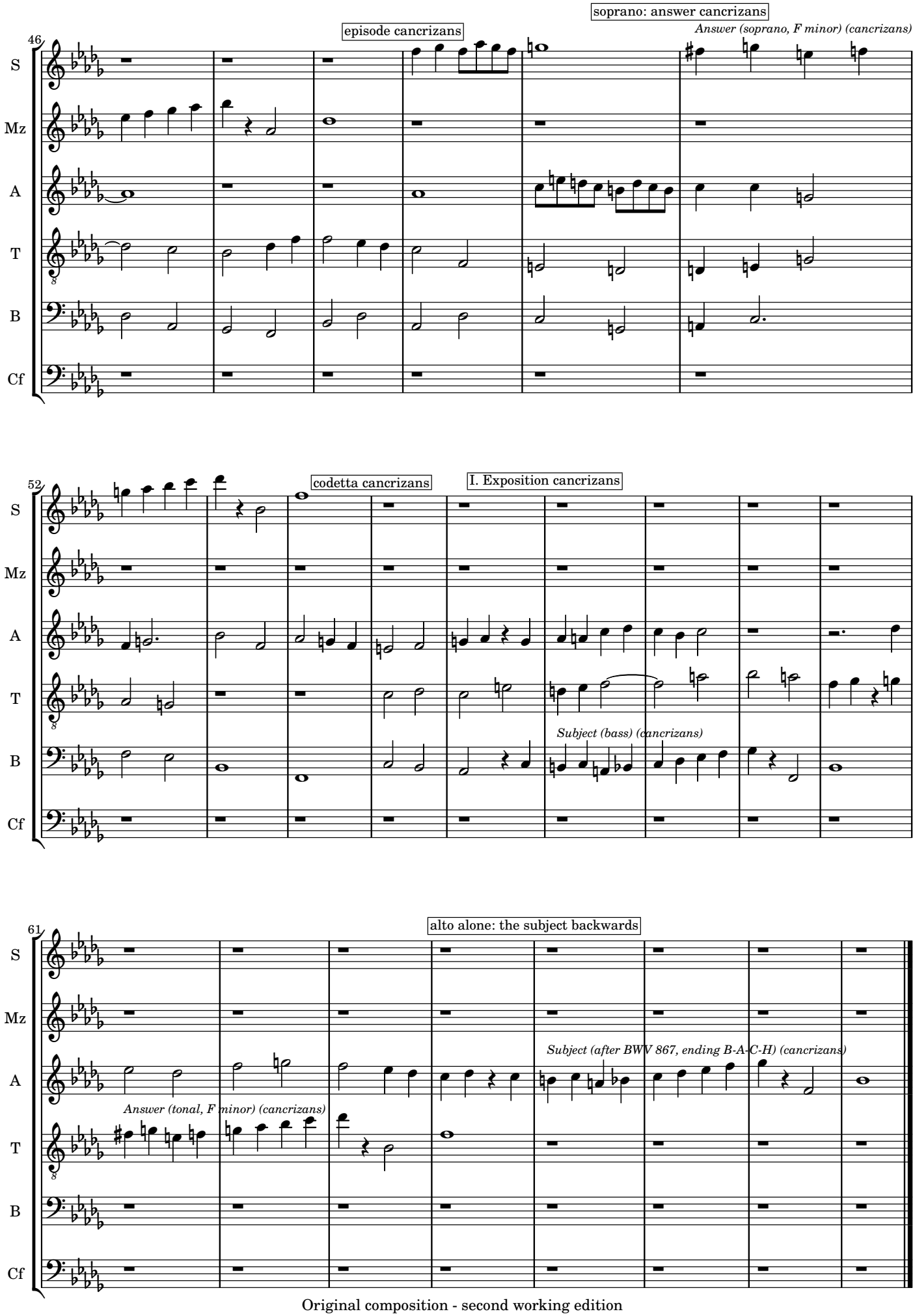
16

episode

II. Middle entry, D-flat major (mezzo-soprano)

Subject in D-flat major (mezzo-soprano)


III. Crux: cantus firmus in augmentation, alto in canon
episode
22
S
Mz
A
T
B
Cf
Subject with its augmentation (canon per augmentationem)
Subject in augmentation (cantus; B-A-C-H on the axis)
Axis: III. Crux cancrizans
B-A-C-H in four transpositions -> axis
30
Subject in augmentation (cantus; B-A-C-H on the axis) (cancrizans)
episode cancrizans
II. cancrizans
39
Subject in D-flat major (mezzo-soprano) (cancrizans)
Subject with its augmentation (canon per augmentationem) (cancrizans)


46
episode cancrizans
soprano: answer cancrizans
Answer (soprano, F minor) (cancrizans)
S
Mz
A
T
B
Cf
52
codetta cancrizans
I. Exposition cancrizans
Subject (bass) (cancrizans)
61
alto alone: the subject backwards
Subject (after BWV 867, ending B-A-C-H) (cancrizans)
Answer (tonal, F minor) (cancrizans)